IMMERSIVE FAN PLATFORM · FAN-SIDE EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Matchday Fan Experience

What it is, what it's meant to do, and every fan feature flow — oriented for preliminary user testing.

Prepared for user-testing planning · Fan surface (public/legacy football prototype + engine panel)

1. What it is

A **second-screen matchday companion** — a phone-shaped, chrome-free web panel a fan opens (via QR / share link) to live *alongside* a match. The pitch: turn passive watching into an active, gamified, social experience — live reactions, chat, predictions, AI insight, shop, quests — driven in real time by an operator in a control room.

What it's meant to do (the vision): be the thing a fan keeps open on their phone for 90 minutes instead of drifting to WhatsApp or X — earning XP, reacting to moments, voting, and buying, all synced to what's happening on the pitch.

READ THIS FIRST

What it actually is today: a high-fidelity **vision prototype**, not a working product. There is no backend, no real data feed, no accounts, no camera, no real video, no payments. Almost every *outcome* is simulated client-side. This is the single most important fact for planning user testing — you are testing **desirability and concept**, not a functioning system.

2. There are two different fan products — know which you're testing

The codebase has two separate fan surfaces. This trips people up.

	Legacy football prototype	Engine panel
Where	`public/legacy/` (raw HTML/JS)	`src/panel/` (React)
Covers	Man City football only	Every other sport (rugby, F1, UFC, basketball, tennis, cricket, esports, conference)
Depth	**Deep** — ~60 screens, stadium services, food ordering, a full matchday	**Broad but shallow** — one generic panel, 9 modules, same shape per sport
Role	The real showcase; what stakeholders have seen	The scalable productization story behind it

RECOMMENDATION

For preliminary fan testing, use the **legacy football prototype** — it's the rich, believable experience. The engine panel is the scaling story, not the demo.

3. How a fan gets in

- **Route:** `/p/:id` (short link, used in QR) or `/panel/:id`. The entire panel config is encoded into the share URL (`?c=…`), so a colleague on a brand-new phone renders the exact panel with no backend — REAL and works offline.
- **First-time gate:** a "Join the FanZone" screen (name, favourite, email, opt-in) or "Continue as guest." Identity + XP persist in the browser. **XP is real and persistent**; everything it unlocks is cosmetic.
- **Legacy standalone entry:** splash → sign-up → 3 onboarding screens → home.

> **TESTING GOTCHA**
>
> A *deployed* fan panel now starts in **manual mode** and **holds on the start screen until an operator drives it**. With no operator connected, a test fan sees a static screen and thinks it's broken. Either run the control room alongside, or use the self-playing walkthrough (§7).

4. The match journey

The experience moves through match phases — but the operator **swaps whole screens; it does not update live numbers.** Every score, clock, and scorer is baked into the HTML.

Pre-Match → Matchday → First Half → Half-Time → Second Half → Full-Time

In **autopilot**, this auto-plays on a scripted ~64-second loop (goal 12s, flash sale 19s, VAR 24s, half-time 30s, MOTM 51s, full-time 57s). In **manual**, the operator triggers each beat.

5. Every fan feature flow

REAL = functional interaction · MOCK = simulated outcome · PARTIAL = real mechanic, faked result

Social & reactions

- **Live Chat** REAL now — a fan can now type and post into the feed, and a canned fan reply follows (fixed today — was previously a dead placeholder). Prototype-local; messages don't cross devices.
- **Fan Reaction Reels** PARTIAL — the TikTok-style video wall. Tiles stream in every ~3s; tap for a full-screen viewer; a "Record your reaction" flow runs a real 3-2-1 countdown and posts a "YOU · LIVE" tile — explicitly "demo — no real capture," images stand in for video. Operator can push a "Featured" reel.
- **Emoji reactions** REAL — tap floats an emoji, bumps a live counter. Cosmetic.

Participation & gamification

- **Moderator Polls** PARTIAL — operator pushes a poll into chat; fan votes; results are random percentages.
- **Moderator Questions** MOCK — a conversation-starter prompt; no answer capture.
- **Man of the Match voting** PARTIAL — pick from 3 fixed players, +XP; no real tally.
- **Predictions** PARTIAL — score picker works; "Lock in predictions" now confirms with feedback (fixed today).
- **Quizzes / star-rating / mood picker** REAL — functional taps; half-time quest "Submit" now confirms (fixed today).

- **Quests / Rewards / Tiers / Leaderboard** MOCK — XP labels are text; leaderboard is static. "Copy Code" now really copies to clipboard (fixed today).

Commerce

- **Shop / Flash Sale** PARTIAL — flash-sale banner has a real countdown; "Add to Bag" now confirms with feedback (fixed today). No real cart/checkout.
- **Food ordering** MOCK — opens a partner ordering site in an in-app iframe; "Place Order" is UI-only.

Content & AI

- **IRIS (AI Q&A)** MOCK — a scripted assistant persona. Suggestion chips route to a canned answer; the "Ask IRIS…" field is a placeholder. No LLM anywhere.
- **Match briefs, news, stats, highlights** MOCK — static editorial and fixed numbers (possession, xG).

Moments (operator / autopilot-driven, not fan-controlled)

- **Event banners** MOCK — goal / VAR / yellow / sub flash up and auto-dismiss; tapping a goal/VAR opens an IRIS "read."
- **Announcements, featured reactions, flash sales** — pushed to the fan by the operator.

Genuinely real, end-to-end

Kickoff **countdown clock** (real system time) · **share sheet** (real Web Share / Twitter / WhatsApp / clipboard) · **light-mode toggle** (persisted) · screen navigation, sliders, swipes · the operator↔fan control plumbing.

6. What this means for user testing

You are testing desirability and concept, not a working product. Frame every session that way.

You CAN validate

- Does the second-screen idea earn attention during a match?
- Which modules do fans gravitate to — reactions? chat? predictions? shop?
- Does the reel wall land? Is navigation intuitive?
- Does gamification / XP motivate?
- Reactions to look-and-feel and concept.

You CANNOT validate yet

- Anything needing a real outcome: real predictions/scoring, actual purchases, real video reactions.
- Cross-device shared chat (prototype-local).
- Live data accuracy.
- Retention across multiple matches.

Pick your test mode carefully:

- **Moderated / observed session** → run the control room and drive the panel live (feels real, shows the operator concept). Needs the Ably key set for a separate phone (§8).
- **Hand it to a fan solo** → use the walkthrough (§7) or the `?auto` self-playing demo, or they'll hit the "stuck on start screen" problem.

7. The walkthrough — your ready-made test artifact

`public/legacy/walkthrough.html` is a **self-contained, no-setup, playable fan journey** built for exactly this. A phone frame + a "Chapters" rail: **Pre-match → Kick-off → Goal! → Half-time → Full-time**, click-through or auto-play (6s/chapter). No operator, no config, no login — the lowest-friction way to put the fan experience in front of someone. (It drives the legacy football prototype, so it does not exercise the engine sports or module library.)

8. Risks & rough edges

Items marked FIXED TODAY were patched in this pass; the rest remain open decisions.

#	Issue	Status
1	**Dead CTAs** — "Lock in predictions", "Add to Bag" (×2), half-time "Submit", "Copy Code" did nothing when tapped.	FIXED TODAY — all now give confirmation feedback; "Copy Code" really copies.
2	**Data inconsistency** — half-time/full-time screen showed opponent "ARS" (Arsenal) while the rest of the app is Real Madrid.	FIXED TODAY — corrected to "RMA" throughout.
3	**Chat couldn't send** — the input bar was a cosmetic placeholder; fans could not post a message.	FIXED TODAY — live-chat input now works (type + send, canned reply follows).
4	**"Stuck on start" in manual mode** — a deployed panel waits for an operator; a solo fan sees a static screen.	DECISION — per session, either drive with the control room or use the walkthrough / `?auto`.
5	**Cross-device control needs the Ably key** (`VITE_ABLY_KEY`). Without it, operator control & shared chat only work in the same browser.	VERIFY — confirm the key is set before any multi-device test.
6	**Minor clock quirk** — the live screen shows 67'/2nd-half while the control bridge labels the first-half state "23'." Cosmetic; the score story (0–0 at half → Haaland 54' → 1–0) is otherwise coherent.	OPEN — low priority.

Bottom line: You have a convincing, richly-built *vision demo* of a matchday companion, strongest on the Man City football path. With today's fixes it's ready to test **concept and desirability** — as long as you drive it with the control room or the walkthrough. The remaining open items in §8 are decisions to make per test session, not blockers.

Immersive Fan Platform — Fan-side executive summary. Prepared for preliminary user testing. Sources: `public/legacy/` (football prototype), `src/panel/` & `src/engine/` (engine panel), `public/legacy/walkthrough.html`.